



The Blueprint

♦ THE SIX HABITS, IN THE ORDER I ACTUALLY DO THEM

None of it is fancy. All of it compounds. Give it four weeks, and take a photo in the same window light on day one.

7:00 Moisturizer inside 60 seconds of the shower
Wet skin still holds water. Dry skin already lost it. Ashy is a timing problem, not a skin type. Cream on damp skin, face to collarbone.

7:05 SPF, two finger lengths, even for the car
UVA comes straight through a windshield, so the window side of your face ages faster. Tinted or a chemical filter so it vanishes on deep skin. No exceptions.

7:20 30g of protein before the coffee
Caffeine on an empty stomach spikes cortisol, and cortisol eats collagen. Eggs, fish, beans, or plain yogurt first, then the coffee.

3 walks 10k steps split into three
After breakfast, after lunch, after dinner. Three small insulin resets beat one long grind, and it shows up in your skin before your jeans.

Puffy? Two minutes of cold metal on the face
A spoon from the fridge, or a ladle. It tightens and de-puffs for about an hour. That is all it does, and it is enough before a photo.

10:30 Bed, phone in the kitchen
Every habit above gets cashed in during deep sleep. Skip it and the rest is decoration. Bonnet on, lights out.

Page 2: the \$15 routine, morning and night

\$15

THE ROUTINE THAT BEATS A \$300 SHELF

The \$15 routine

Three products: a gentle fragrance free cleanser, a moisturizer with glycerin or ceramides, and an SPF 30 that vanishes on deep skin. Store brands, about \$5 each (2026).

♦ MORNING · 3 MINUTES

☐ Rinse with lukewarm water, or cleanse for 60 seconds if last night was shea or sweat.

☐ Pat, never rub. Leave the skin damp.

☐ Moisturizer inside 60 seconds, a grape sized amount, face and neck, while the skin is still damp.

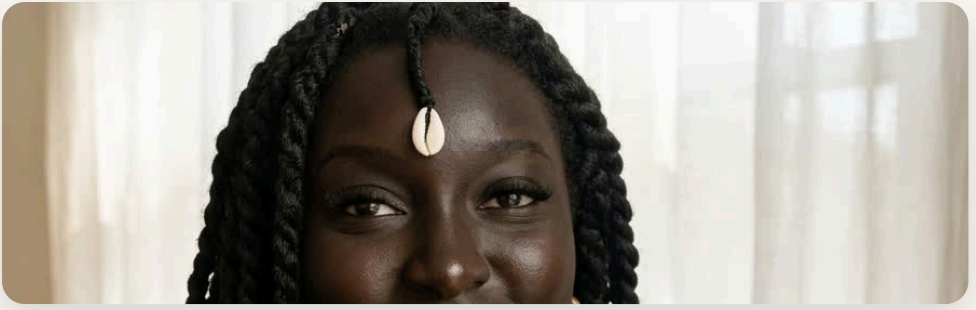
☐ Wait one minute. Then sunscreen, SPF 30 or higher, two finger lengths for face and neck.

♦ NIGHT · 3 MINUTES

☐ Cleanse for a full 60 seconds with lukewarm water. Count it. Most women stop at fifteen.

☐ Moisturizer inside 60 seconds, a grape sized amount, pressed in with warm hands, face to collarbone.

The rule that does not break: Sunscreen every morning, indoors, in December, under a cloud, no exceptions. It outperforms every serum you will ever buy.



Want the other 206?

This page is six of the 212 secrets in The African Beauty Code. The book is the rest: the sun rules, the barrier, shea and black soap done right, the one active and the two nights a week I use it, dark spots, the sugar habit aging Senegal faster than the sun, hair, and the bleaching chapter every Black woman should read once.

Every secret is tagged honestly: **strong science**, **promising**, or **tradition**. When the science is thin, the page says so. No supplements, no miracles, nothing that lightens skin tone.

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The African Beauty Code · 442 pages · 6 printable companions · **\$19.99**

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With love, from Dakar to wherever you are.

KHADY